

SOUTHEASTERN



Free Will Baptist College

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THE SIN OF INGRATITUDE

By Billy Bevan

As we approach another Thanksgiving season, and as we at Southeastern reminisce over 10 years of ministry, certainly all of us have much for which to be thankful. Yet as we look around us, everybody seems to want more and more for less and less.

Many of us set aside one day a year for Thanksgiving and then devote the rest of the year to a spirit of "ingratitude." God is not pleased with that spirit. To the New Testament Christian the Lord says, "Give thanks always for all things."

Dr. Criswell, from the First Baptist Church in Dallas, Texas, tells a story of a wretched woman he encountered on visitation in the first church he pastored in Oklahoma. After the woman shared her pathetic life story, a story of tragedy and loss, desperation, poor health, and bitterness, she asked if she might share some of her poetry with Dr. Criswell before he left. He agreed to listen and this was the poem he heard:

*I hate Oklahoma! Not the land of my native birth,
But a land, by all the gods that be,
a scourge on the face of the earth.*

I hate Oklahoma!

*I hate Oklahoma! Where the centipede crawl
in your bed at night,*

Where the rattlesnake lifts its fangs to bite,

*Where the lizard and the scorpion play on the sly,
And the lonesome vultures sail high in the sky.*

Where water and food are an eternal lack,

And man's best friend sticks a dagger in his back.

I HATE OKLAHOMA!

She offered him a whole sheath of poetry. It was **all** like that! Dr. Criswell said he had never seen such an angry, bitter, ungrateful, unthankful, old woman. A few weeks after his visit, the woman died, and before her death she had left word that she wanted Dr. Criswell to preach her funeral. Dr. Criswell said it was the most memorable funeral service he had ever preached; for the only person who was at the service was the corpse in the casket. Not one person came...for you see, ingratitude has no friends!

May God help us to understand that ingrati-

Decade
of
Destiny

tude is a sin, and I believe it bothers and grieves the heart of God as much as anything we Christians do.

Look around you to all your prosperity, to all the wonderful people you know, and even to the problems God is using in His unique plan to shape and mold your life. Look above to the God in heaven, who has given you more reasons to be grateful than ninety per cent of the inhabitants of this globe will ever know. Then--with your heart filled--say to God, "Thank you! Thank you for what you've done for me, for what you mean to me, and for what you are to me!"

May God help each of us, in every word, in every deed, in every place, to be a thankful, grateful Christian!



SPECIAL THANKS

Marlene Pannkuk of First FWB Church, Raleigh, NC, volunteered her services this past summer to help in our library. Thanks, Mrs. Pannkuk, for your interest in this ministry.

Recently, *Rodney Radford*, Goldsboro, NC, contributed books to our library which will be of great assistance to our students.

Faith Church, Goldsboro, NC, recently allowed us to use one of their buses for a trip to King's Dominion. *Eddie & Ruth Smith* and *Jeff & Della Stocks* are to be commended for their assistance with this trip.

Special thanks to *Tim Young*, Cramerton, NC, who works with BBN, for his assistance with advice regarding our sound system and for help with speakers and stands. You have really been a blessing, Bro. Tim.

STUDENTS SELECTED FOR WHO'S WHO

The 1993 edition of Who's Who Among Students in American Universities and Colleges will include the names of 7 students from Southeastern Free Will Baptist College who have been selected as national outstanding leaders.

The campus nominating committee and editors of the annual directory have included the names of these students based on their academic achievement, service to the community, leadership in extracurricular activities and potential for continued success.

They join an elite group of students selected from more than 1,400 institutions of higher learning in all 50 states, the District of Columbia and several foreign nations.

Outstanding students have been honored in the annual directory since it was first published in 1934.

Students named this year from Southeastern Free Will Baptist College are:

Shannon Dunn, Durham, NC

Pamela Farley, Kannapolis, NC

Gary Goodfellow, Virginia Beach, VA

Devin Hudson, Amory, MS

Dwayne James, Birmingham, AL

Matt Pettit, Newport News, VA

Christian Powell, Raleigh, NC.



Spotlight on Alumni

Lena Pittman graduated from Southeastern in 1990 with a B.S. degree. Since graduation she has been employed by Gateway Christian School, Virginia Beach, Virginia, where she teaches 7th and 8th grade math and science. Lena also teaches a Sunday School class and sings in the church choir.



Hemant Patel received his B.A. degree in 1990 from Southeastern. He began teaching at Faith Christian Academy, Goldsboro, North Carolina, in the fall of 1990. He is still ministering at Faith Free Will Baptist Church and Christian school as an assistant to the pastor, teacher and coach. He also has a bus route.



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Dr. M. A. Thomas, with **Christ for India**, was on campus on September 17. Our hearts were moved as he spoke of the persecution he and his friends have endured and even martyrdom by some. From a small beginning in 1960 of tract distribution, the ministry has grown to 350 churches and missions, over 60 schools, 8 Bible institutes and 8 orphanages, a seven-day radio program a week, 20,000 students in correspondence studies, a hospital, medical dispensary and a printing ministry which gets out over 1,000,000 gospel tracts and 100,000 gospel packets each year.

S.A.C.S. PRESENTS SCHOLARSHIPS

Dr. Randy Cox, president of The Southeastern Association of Church Schools, presented scholarships to three Southeastern college students October 16 in chapel. These scholarships are awarded by the association to aid students preparing to teach in Free Will Baptist Christian day schools.

Students receiving the scholarships this year were Jennifer Chenault, Virginia Beach, Virginia, Thach Jacobs, Raleigh, North Carolina, and Shara Scott, Charlotte, North Carolina.

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How Southeastern Has Influenced My Life!

They say that the life of a college student is difficult. The truth of the matter is, in my case, that it has been wonderful. The great God of heaven has provided everything for my family and me while attending Southeastern. Through the leadership of the faculty, I have learned to love Jesus more, also to love and appreciate His church more, and my heart has been burdened for a world that stands in need of my Saviour. The wonderful friends that the Lord has given me here have not only been real friends, but they have become like brothers and sisters to me. I'm thankful to God that his destiny for me was to come to this college. It has helped me to know Jesus better and has cultivated a more earnest desire to make Him known to my fellow-man.



Rev. David Austin, Clarksville, Tennessee

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Students, Faculty and Staff ☆☆☆ Greet ☆☆☆ Vice-President, Dan Quayle

On October 15, 1992, the student body, along with the faculty and staff, was privileged to be a part of a rally at the Wal-Mart in Knightdale in support of Vice-President Dan Quayle. The Vice-President was manning a bus tour through the middle part of North Carolina and in particular, was on his way to Rocky Mount to attend a rally. Because of the many supporters in Knightdale, Vice-President Quayle made an impromptu visit, much to the delight of all present, especially those of us from Southeastern.

Many of the students were able to shake the Vice-President's hand and all of us were able to encourage him with shouts and cheers. Mrs. Terri Siebert even gave him a quartet tape personally and received a promise that he would listen to it. At the least, we do know the Vice-President has good taste in music!

Besides shaking hands, the Vice-President also gave a rousing speech in support of President Bush. This occasion was no doubt a very exciting one for the students and faculty of Southeastern and is definitely one of the highlights of the semester!

WHAT A RETREAT!!!

The 1992 Missions Retreat was a grand success as it provided students with a full weekend of services, testimonies, and fun. Rev. Fred Hersey, senior missionary to Japan, informed the students about Japan as well as how God worked in his life to lead him there. Students quickly discovered that Mr. Hersey is not a stereotypical senior missionary as he skated, played ping-pong and acted crazier than the students.

Also at the retreat were Tim and Rosemarie Baumgarten, short term missionaries to France. The Baumgartens told about their year in Rennes and about the people who came to know the Lord through their English Bible studies.

Fred McCracken and his children were responsible for our recreation which included a physical and mental obstacle course which will not be forgotten for a long time.

Lake Waccamaw provided a beautiful background for God to begin renovation of our lives. We are praising God for the works which He began at this year's retreat and are trusting Him to complete these works for His glory!

*Amy Mainus, Junior
Tulsa, Oklahoma*